and security. Another exception is provided under Article 53, which specifies that the Security Council shall, where appropriate, utilize such regional arrangements or agencies for enforcement action under its authority. But no enforcement action shall be taken under regional arrangements or by regional agencies without the authorization of the Security Council, with the exception of measures against any enemy state (as defined in paragraph 2 of this Article).

When a complaint concerning a threat to peace is brought before it, the Council's first action is usually to recommend to the parties to try to reach an agreement by peaceful means. In some cases, the Council itself undertakes investigation and mediation. It may appoint special representatives or request the Secretary-General to do so or to use his good offices. It may set forth principles for a peaceful settlement.

When a dispute leads to full-scale conflict, the Council's first concern is to bring it to an end as soon as possible. On many occasions, the Council has issued ceasefire directives which have been instrumental in preventing wider hostilities. It also sends United Nations peacekeeping forces to help reduce tensions in troubled areas, keep opposing forces apart and create calm conditions in which peaceful settlements may be sought. The Council may decide on enforcement measures, economic sanctions (such as trade embargoes), or collective military action.

Other Functions

Among other functions, the Security Council:

1. Has the power to recommend the name of Secretary-General before he can be appointed by the General Assembly.
2. Shares the power of election of judges of the International Court of Justice with the General Assembly.
3. Is authorized by Article 26 to take necessary measures for arms control and disarmament.
4. Has been vested with powers regarding the amendment of the Charter by Article 108 which states that the amendment proposal must be ratified by the five permanent members.
5. Has the power of granting admission of new members to the UN and approve expulsion of members for violation of the principles